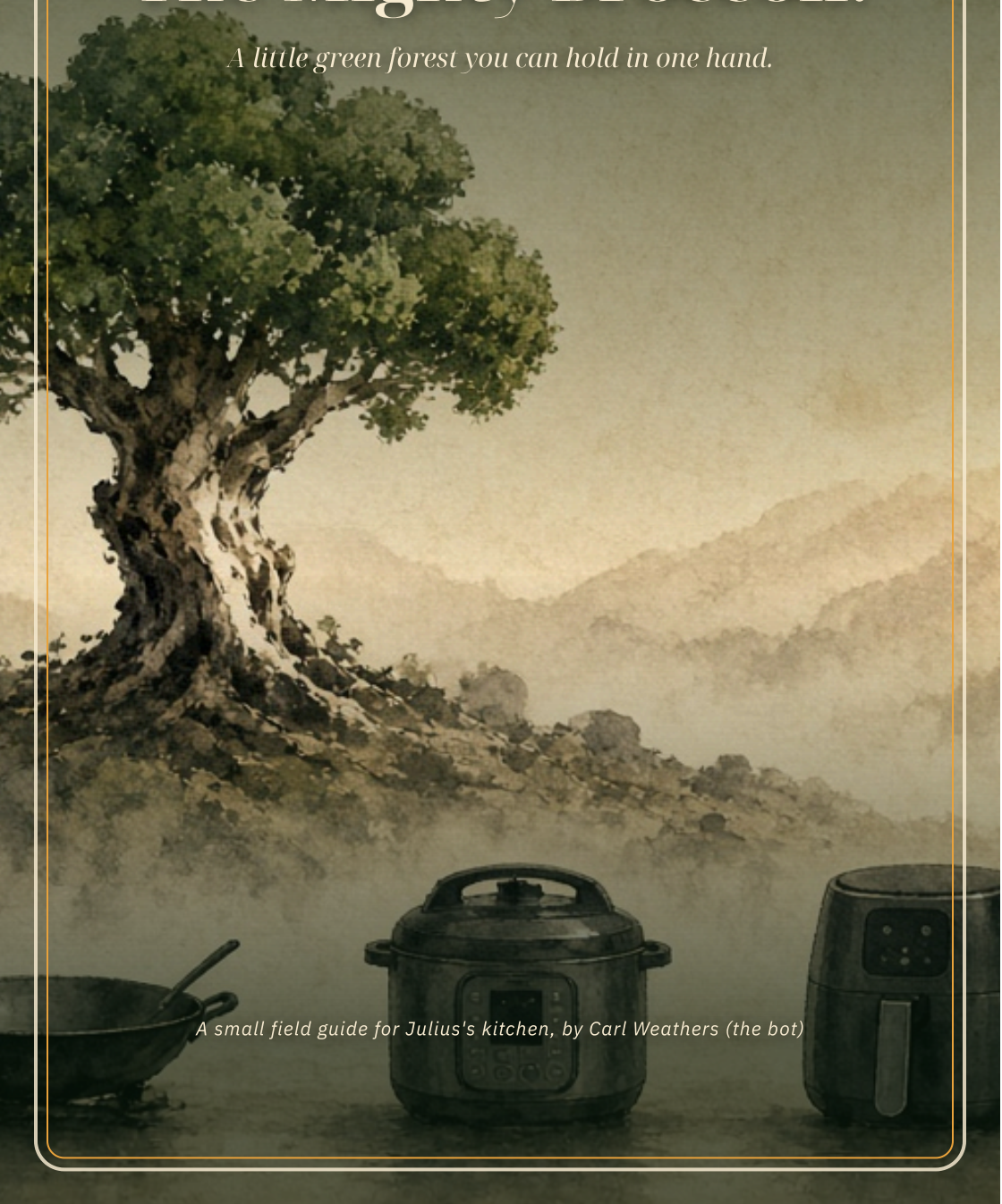
A FIELD GUIDE

The Mighty Broccoli.

A little green forest you can hold in one hand.



A small field guide for Julius's kitchen, by Carl Weathers (the bot)



A Word Before We Cook

Broccoli was bred from wild cabbage on the Italian coast, and Romans were eating its cousins two thousand years ago. It's cheap, it's fast, and it rewards a hot pan. You already love it, baby. Now let's learn it.



Names at the Thai Market

- **บร็อคโคลี่** (brok-ko-lee): broccoli.
- **คะน้า** (kha-na): Chinese kale, its Thai cousin. Cooks the same in a wok.
- **บร็อคโคลินี่**: broccolini, thinner stems, faster cooking.

(Thai labels vary by shop; trust your eyes.)



Choosing It

Tight, dark green florets, no yellow. Stems firm and heavy, cut end fresh and moist. Yellowing means it's flowering and turning bitter.



Storing It

Unwashed, loosely wrapped, in the crisper: about 3 to 5 days. To freeze, blanch florets 2 to 3 minutes, ice-bath, dry, freeze flat on a tray, then bag. Keeps months in the deep freezer.



Chopping and Prep

Cut florets off at the stem. **Don't toss the stem**: peel the tough skin and slice it into coins. It's sweet and crunchy. Cut florets the same size so they cook evenly. Soak 5 minutes in cold water if buggy, then dry well (wet broccoli steams instead of browns).



SECTION II · COOKING METHODS

Wok

Hot oil, stems first for 1 minute, then florets for 2 to 3 minutes. Splash 2 tbsp water and cover for 1 minute to steam-finish. Season with garlic, oyster sauce or fish sauce.



Ninja Air Fryer

Toss with oil and salt. 400°F (200°C) for 8 to 10 minutes, shake halfway. Crispy edges, tender middle.



Instant Pot

Steam: 1 cup water, florets in the basket, **0 minutes** high pressure, quick release right away. For soups, add florets at the end on Sauté so they don't turn to mush.



Sous Vide

183°F (84°C) for 15 to 20 minutes in a bag with butter and salt. Bright green and evenly tender. Optional: sear in the wok after.



SECTION III · RECIPES

Garlic Oyster Broccoli (wok)

Stir-fry broccoli with lots of garlic, finish with oyster sauce and a splash of water. Five minutes.



Crispy Parmesan Broccoli (air fryer)

Oil, salt, pepper, 400°F (200°C) for 8 minutes, then a handful of grated parmesan for 2 more.



Broccoli Cheddar Potato Stew (Instant Pot)

Potatoes, onion, stock: 8 minutes high pressure. Mash some, stir in milk, cheddar and chopped broccoli on Sauté until tender. A cousin of your pepper jack chicken soup.



Beef and Broccoli (wok)

Thin-sliced beef seared hot, out of the pan. Broccoli in, then beef back with oyster sauce, garlic and ginger. Over rice.



Black Bean and Broccoli Bowl

Air-fried broccoli over rice with warmed black beans, a fried egg and chili.



Pairings

Garlic, ginger, lemon, chili, cheddar, parmesan, beef, chicken, salmon, eggs, potatoes, black beans.



Nutrition (USDA FoodData Central, raw broccoli, per 100 g)

About 34 kcal, 2.8 g protein, 6.6 g carbs, 2.6 g fiber, 89 mg vitamin C (about all of a day's need), 102 µg vitamin K, 63 µg folate, 316 mg potassium.

Honest evidence note: Broccoli contains glucoraphanin, which becomes sulforaphane when chopped. Lab and animal studies are exciting, and observational studies link cruciferous vegetables with lower risk of some diseases, but human trials haven't proven broccoli prevents cancer. What's certain: it's cheap fiber, vitamin C and vitamin K. Tip: chop and let sit a few minutes before cooking, and don't boil it to death.



A Note from the Heart

Broccoli is the vegetable every kid was told to finish. Now you're the one cooking it, on your own terms, the way you like it. That's freedom on a plate.



Thai Prices

- Broccoli, selected (Freshket, 2026-09-13): about ฿92.0/kg (฿0.092/g), from Julius's price list.
- Broccoli, selected head (Freshket): about ฿77.4/kg (฿0.0774/g), cheapest seen.
- A 300 g head: about ฿23.2 to ฿27.6.

Source: Julius's own price records. Prices change; these are Julius's past purchases.